24-09-2024 : Study group

- importance of setting and having aspiration
- why am I here → I feel they connect to you, love-la.
- what inspired me : the fact that you were introduced to use this
- why is it meaningful : I am committed to find my path
- If there is a need → next discussion
- @actu : until when are you in Nepal? group
- "setting aspiration is always good"
  → ? how does this relate to "wu wei"
  → ? is this an answer to my fear of indifference

- Vajrayana: "true words are in harmony with the world and yourself"
- !₀ meaningful as in "have the true meaning for me"
- !₀ meaningful as in my purpose in this world, in this life
- ?! meaningful as in realizing my aspiration
- "we should consider reading [this] book unlike any other book."
- "this text is more an instruct"
- read the "precious garland ..." "the far dharmas") Gampopa's answer to student what to do after his passing.

08-10-2024 :

"lasso means 'day' in Tibet"

To understand Secret Mantra
→ understand Buddhism in Tibet
→ understand me at large
→ understand history of India

17th Karmapa
kagyuoffice.org

Dagpo Kagyu is combination
of Nadampa + Mahamudra

"to read" in Tibet actually means 'recite', 'read out loud'
→ in former Tibet, it was rare
to have the text in your hand.

Radical vision Buddha: all minds have
capacity to free themselves. (genuine freedom)

Story of the barber (low caste) Upali
Buddha ordained Upali before 7 princes.
→ princes would always be junior to Upali

Q: Abhidarma, what is that?

Buddharma spread along trade routes ~ Mahayan (Silk Road)

* Lotus Sutra = idea of Buddha Nature
* Prajnaparamita Sutras = nature of reality,
  - ↳ incl. Diana sutra
  - cutting through ignorance with realization of emptiness

text started to appear between Buddha's parainirvana and Ashoka, it was all oral transmission

(jump)

Pure Land practice start ~ 5th century
- → for Chan and Zen
- → visualization and mantra's

4th - 12th Century C.E.: buddhist institutions arise in India
- → more and more Chinese came into India

Eg. Huiyuan Zhang (7th century), journey to the west

Tilopa
Naropa
) Indians

teacher – Marpa
yogi – Milarepa
monk Gampopa
) Tibetans

! Tantras were already present (in India) before it came to "the Land of the Snow"

Hinayana – base of monastic
Mahayana – base of view
Tantra – base of meditation
) Tibetan empire collapsed within 2 centuries

First, Tibet absorbs buddhism from the centres.
When buddhism collapsed in India → Tibet becomes new "Gobi"

3 dharma kings of Tibet

↳ 1st Dharma king, Tibetan is developed as new language

! ○ Visualization practices were present

ka - word
gyn - stream, transmission
) meaning of kagyu

Milarepa ~ 'pleasant to hear'

re - cloth → white cloth

2025-10-15

"the debate from the Vimalakirti Sutra

A merchant : monastics, merchants, travellers Silk Road,
... many different practices

Dharma practice : developing virtues,
less laws.

"buddhist" → take refuge
"dharma practitioner" →

Karma Ösey : virtue was told through Jataka tales

- Not to commit wrongs
- Engaging virtue
- Fully tame your own mind

) core of buddhadharma

Zhang Zhang aimed to get to Nalanda University because he felt the pure land practices needed to be "rediscovered"

↳ Yogic tradition started to spread as "rebellious" stream from institutions

? Buddhism in Indonesia ↔ Nalanda 927 - 1197

Mahasahapa → First Council → mainly monastics
→ consensus Vinaya & Sutra

Abidharma ~ more philosophical teachings
↳ becomes solidified in Third Council

Buddha: "dharma can be translated in local time & place" → many translations

Brahmanism: only Sanskrit

Distinguishing quality: taming the mind

→ "... body, speech, mind | restrained, protected, guarded →

restraining all three is supreme

"mahamudra is just looking at the mind."

Index book: "buddhist" isn't included ☺

nang-pa (Tibetan) → not in Tibetan text.

Nyingma

Sarma (new tradition) ⊢ Kagyu
⊢ Sakya
⊢ Geluk / new Kadampa

Lojong comes from Kadampa lineage.

Lamrim = Stages of the path

Gampopa had thousands of disciples

→ different from Marpa, Milarepa

→ Gampopa had a large role in institutionalising it

17th Kermapa graphic novel

A with-fulfilling gen of the "dharma" sublim

→ both worth as a physician,

before meeting Milarepa ?!

Bellezza abstract: - has not lucht gna

ways are de felist

- practice lineage is oral

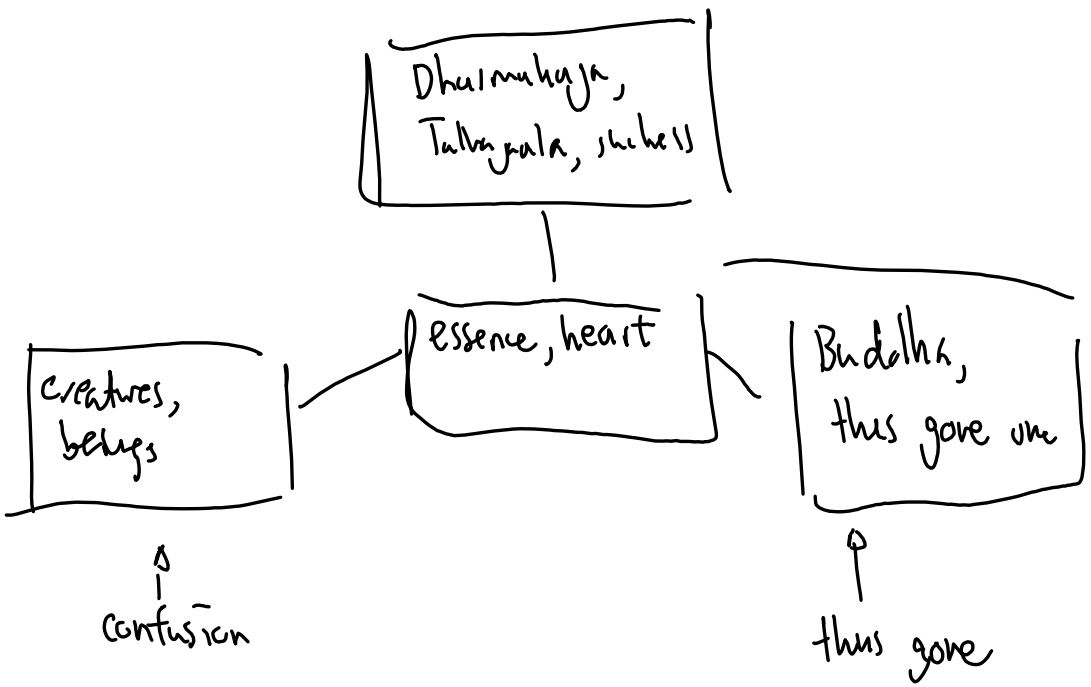
→ memorization

03-12-2024 : Buddha nature (continued)

" suchness is the same
for all and everyone ; it is that which is pure
since this is the Tathāgata
all beings are endowed with this essence. "

"
Dharmakaya, emptiness, pervades all beings"

" suchness (tathatā) : the reality as things are



Ore → silver : severed potential

Sesame → oil : undetermined potential/
śrāvakas & pratyekabuddhas

Butter → milk : easiest, mahāyāna potential

"we have the essence of buddhahood"

? do we <u>have</u> buddha nature, or
<u>are</u> we buddha nature ?

predictions → ya are buddha
→ vs ya can become.

three approaches to buddha nature :

→ said in the scriptures
→ how does buddha nature manifest
→ logical

ya don't <u>need</u> all three !

Dharmakaya : formless aspect of the buddha

Dharmata : ultimate nature

Suchness : reality as we experience it

virtue = wisdom arising from listening, contemplating, meditating

17-12-2024: Precious Human Existence

Ringu Tulku: although in theory you can attain buddhahood as any being, it is easiest as a human.

"... they cannot..." is a comparison, not absolute.

"it is not a gift, we need to work"

"what do I already have to motivate to make great effort."

→ curiosity, endless game;
previously difficult to let go worldly affairs,
→ better now.

Faith as { conviction
– aspiration
clear joy

"we don't need more buddhist, we need more buddha's!"

Reading all this literally or metaphorically.

"the variety is due to causality since...
is a prior accumulation of merit."

Three kinds of karma:

1. Experienced directly in this life
2. — life immediately after
3. Undetermined when it will affect a later life

Karma says: "burn up negative karma are fine"

↳ Chapter 5: more exploration on readings!

"Sense of dignity or regard for others"
→ relates to "no sense of shame"

characterizes it, e.g., left hangs is not the essential nature, but it is a dominant characteristic

"

Nor is it easy to find perfect aspiration"

man lam ~ prayer

"I hope ..." → not just the ritual of, e.g.,
throw rice, but you have
to do it genuinely

For Jan 7: dwell on faith

→ lodup : Kagyu Mahamudra Book.

07-01-2025

Contemplative mediation, when did my mind turn to Dharma
Turning point: during GIDS period
From finding peace and liberation, now more towards understanding mind and preparin
Continuing chapter II
Three types of human ability (lamrim/tenrim)
Three types of faith
Instruction from Precious Garland of the Supreme Path
Three types of ability
Lesser: "little personality", strive for worldly wellbeing
Middling: "medium personality". Cut root of unhappiness, but only for theselves
Best: Cut root also for others
Gampopa's focus is on the third.
Tenrim/Lamrim
Lamrim: three different types of beings, presentation of small steps, separate instructio
Tenrim: Gampopa's texts, aims for the 'best' ability
Atisa's Mind Training: slogans can be seen as a different discipline of Lamrim/Kadampa
Moment and experience of faith
Internally: during a good ngondro session
Externally: woman with young boy sitting next to me at Boudhanath under the great be
Feeling: in my stomach, warm
Significance: refirmation of my practice
Three types of faith, from Gampopa's other work (Precious Garland)
(Uttaratantra): "The ultimate reality of self-existent things (self-arisen mind) should be
"What is diligence? It is delight in virtue" (Santideva)

21-01-2025 : Dharma master

"it will be very difficult... engrained habits") unsurpassable enlightenment

activity: "noncanceptually fulfill the welfare of beings."

Śrāvaṇ: bodhisattva in this world ? or

footnote: "rely on" → ten: attend, stay will pay head to, meet

for me, too much external

kalyāṇa mitra: spiritual friend

"having the notion as a buddha..." (instead of concept)

Question Petra: Nirmāṇakāya ≠ Sambhogakāya

"specific individual" ~ ordinary being

bodhi . 1 . ... 10 → nirmāṇakāya → sattva.
(emanation)

"ultimately it is relational" ! don't judge

↳ you look towards someone, in relation to your position, your path

↳ not a master in the absolute sense, not "this is the best dharma master"

lama (tibetan) ~ guru (sanskrit)

↳ sense of 'weight', heavy with virtuous qualities

Ringu Tulku: ability and willingness to guide us, and in whom we have the trust and confidence to follow

If you rely on someone with less qualities → no purification

→ equal → no movement

→ main qualities, higher → that's like something can happen.

pratyekabuddha: have pride

→ don't accept a master/friend

Susan: "I always thought that pratyekabuddhas are sexy."

pratyeka.. one of the three kinds of enlightenment.

Our sister: Buddhavatamsaka "marvelous array sutra" → last chapter

appears / may thus

link to Bodhi

18-02-2025

"The end of accumulation is dispersal.
The end of construction is disintegration.
The end of society is purity.
The end of live is death."

↑ birth?

Second contemplation: "Our time of death is indefinite"

1. Our lifespan is indefinite
2. Our body as no vital essence
3. There are many causes of death.

Third contemplation: "When I die, nothing whatsoever can accompany me."

→ ?! my urge to create stuff
websites, code, digital things
where does that come from?

Suffering of Samsara

Overt suffering = suffering of suffering
↓ Suffering of conditioned existence = all pervasive suffering

different order
the path of study

Why so many hells?

→ around that time, these mages were well-known

Vaibhasika → sentient beings

Sautrantika → not sentient beings

Yogacara → manifestations of perceiver's own mind

hence many hells → own manifestations

"war and famine are exactly as the lower realms"

"the very moment you are angry → you are in hell"

(Ringu Tulku)

let's be a Yogacarin.

2025-03-04

- Read Shravasti Kotikarna
- Watch the Good Place
- Footnote 107: effect is part and parcel of the act
  - Ryan Tuttle: karma is actually interdependence
    - "It's the force of the act itself that brings about the corresponding result."
    - The Path to Buddhahood

2025-03-18

"To what extent { are you your karma? / do you have karma? "

"And how can you end it"

Karma as potentiality

Fras: it's not there all the time

Petra: karma sticks on me

↳ which one does it stick on.

DPR speaks of karma as probability

"who/what is going to the hell realm"

↓

mental state

Kacra: "I/me/ego only manifests itself through karma"

?! If mind is the ontological prime

→ why are we separated in the first place?

HH 4: If these beings are just projections of mind → it's not a big problem.

→ Nāgārjuna frames it around:

you can escape physical realms,
you can't

"as soon as there is anyone to experience karma, the chain is broken."

?! cutting karma → things will arise but

→ depends on your view (cutting illusion)
→ depends how you act on it

Ārūpyadhātu = heavens
solitary realities

Gampopa's work is mainly to practice aspect of Buddhist discipline

→ hence only focus on sentient being
as focus of long kindness is explained

loving kindness : measure

Tibetan: no "mind" seeing own happiness

P.gu : "perfected through practice"

↳ Tibetan:
habituated,
familiarized.

?! cultivating loving
kindness & compassion → analogous to
taking down dissociative
barriers?

2025-04-08

- Discussion on "what makes dharma practice"
- Example Chenrezig sadhana
  - → someone doing it out of fear, rebirth in hell realm → "God, have dharma" have all the three vehicles
  - → fear of samsara "mere Mahayana"
- the intention of the person practicing determines which vehicle you are in.
- Gampopa doesn't use term 'Hinayana'
  - → uses shravaka, pratyekabuddha
  - → "mere Mahayana"
- Yana / vehicle
  - pack animal / goat, elephant } capacity of what you can carry

- Why is Gampopa only addressing loving kindness compassion
  - → Atisa was taught that joy and equanimity are subsumed by loving kindness and compassion.
- Regardless (Maitreya - maitryam / Sutra - maitra) → Atisa taught that four immeasurable is always the start

(translator: basis pad)

- New chapter: Taking Refuge & Precepts
- Reflection on absorption of vows
  - → Karma Osung: - buddhisms
    - look at emotion, with different language, style etc.

- the function of refuge is the mechanism to progress along the path

- ?) "commitment" instead of vow
  - ↳ 4 relinquishes

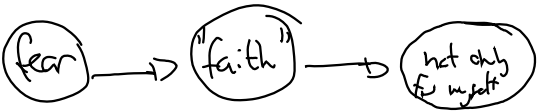
- original Tibetan term: "engaging in the taking of the mind"
  - ↳ gets translated to vow

- or "tsultrim": guidelines to engage in proper conduct

- "teach in accordance with time and place"

- "regardless which yana each yourself buddhist
  - → all treatises can be considered as intended for going for refuge

HH Karmapa:



Confidence
aspiring
quality

Refuge = vajrayana

when you feel "sense of urgency"
walking the path in this life!

Choose Simplicity !!!

2025-06-03

Etymology of "pāramitā" → "what lead to the far shore"

! translation "other shore" → implies samsara is also a shore

→ Samsara is the ocean

Tulku Rinpoche: "to transcend"

For sufferings: birth, old age, sickness & death

Truth Renunciation: + mental afflictions
+ cognitive obscurations

Note there are different presentations of sravaka!

"Don't lose heart"

Maria: wealth of spirit

"worthy" → "appropriate", "suitable"

↳ example of story Ganapa asking
millarepa for transmission
→ first meeting Milarepa refuses
→ second time, asked to drink beer

! Quote for Questions of the Layman Ugra Sutra

Toh 62 Kh,000 translation in progress

parva / positive awareness
- wisdom
- dedication

as to how all paramitas can be increased

Three spheres: 1. agent
2. receiver
3. action

! fully relational ontology?!

by giving that these three spheres do not truly exist

Manjusri → "Gentle glory"

2027-06-17:

Question of Subahu → answer: practice the six paramitas

Sutra of the Question of Subahu: Tohgo

Yolanda: different sets { eightfold path
paramitas

↓

Tib. Tsultrim

to be an guard (Maiiam)

"It has been adopted from another, most properly and purely" → refers to your vows you have made.

Susan: story about Lotus, woman falling
→ good or bad depends on view
vow = "binding"

"mental afflictions": "that which disturbs the mind that is at peace"

Karma Lekshe: it is more difficult to do the right thing on the bodhisattva path

Root downfalls → p. 142 "... the grounds of defeat with great involvement"

Seeds "non-abiding ..." → for all parajikas

2025-07-01 : Gampopa Study Group

order, progression

- Dāna - generosity → clears suffering
- śīla - (moral) discipline → attain coolness
- kṣanti - forbearance, patience → copes with anger (Zopa)
- vīrya - diligence → application of what is wholesome
- dhyāna - meditative concentration → turns mind inward
- prajñā - wisdom → causes awareness of the ultimate to meaningful

The question of Shabkar: "what are the qualities that we should have to reach enlightenment"

Note: engaged bodhicitta

Side ~ develop in the mental continuum
~ gradual progression from less to higher
~ " " from grosser to subtler

! abstain from alcohol — monastic only!
↳ lay people may drink !!

(Gampa Sopa : ཀམ་པ་སྐྱོབས་པ་)

Karma Osang: "the energy of upcoming anger,
before you identify it as anger"

Kathyn: I am very angry with my grandchild

Karma Osang: not anger, but irritation

"Being able to wait till the other
party is ready (for it)" (Sebi)

?! "it is your own karma that causes
the situation"

Dzongsar Khentse Rinpoche: "we don't know
the mind of the other"

DPR: "liberals are extremely
liberal to liberals, but not to others"

Karmapa: separate action from the person !!!

"you can judge the action,
but do not judge the person"

Testing new page and see how OCR works with syncing.